browser is called the *Document Object Model (DOM)*. Objects provided by the document are called *DOM objects*, and *all* DOM objects are host objects. DOM objects, such as `document`, are often a source of frustration.

How do you deal with incompatibilities in the host objects of different browsers? By using polyfills.

11.3.1. Polyfilling host objects

A *polyfill* is a function or group of functions that makes a smooth surface on which your main program can be written, without having to worry about the inconsistencies. It comes from *polyfilla* (also known as *spackling paste*)—a product that's used to fill in gaps and cracks on a wall to create a smooth surface, just like Scruffy and Agtron are doing in figure 11.3. A polyfill in a web browser works the same way—filling in the gaps and cracks between the different browsers.

Figure 11.3. Scruffy and Agtron using a polyfill